Checking a small CSV import

Use this guide to review a small CSV before using its data. Work on a copy, keep the original unchanged and hold anything you cannot confirm.

Independent AI-assisted format study. All data and rules below are synthetic; this is not a client commission or a safety course.

Learning objectives

Check required fields, formats and duplicate IDs; reconcile ready and held rows with the source; record unresolved issues and a release decision.

Review the sample

For this exercise, order_id must be unique, order_date must use YYYY-MM-DD, and amount_usd must contain a number that is zero or greater. These rules are specific to the sample.

Source row	order_id	order_date	amount_usd
2	A101	2026-10-01	25.00
3	A102	2026-10-01	(blank)
4	A102	2026-10-02	18.00
5	A104	2026-10-03	32.00

Source row is a reference label, not a CSV field. The header is row 1. “(blank)” means empty.

Check and reconcile

1. Check the preview. Confirm the delimiter, three expected fields and four data rows. Keep IDs as text and confirm the intended date and number formats.

2. Flag uncertain rows. Source row 3 has no amount. Rows 3 and 4 share A102. Hold both A102 rows; ask the data owner to resolve the ID and missing amount.

3. Reconcile the result. Four source rows = two ready rows + two held rows. Compare values with the original too; matching counts alone do not prove accuracy.

4. Record a decision. Release A101 and A104 only if partial import is approved. Otherwise hold the entire import. Recheck corrections before releasing held rows.

Keep a review log: source filename/version, check date, row counts, affected rows, issues, owner response and release decision.

Practice and answer key

Use the synthetic data and rules on page 1. Answer the five questions before checking the key. No new source information is needed.

1 Protect the source

What should you do with the original CSV before editing the import?

Answer: _____

2 Check required values

Which source row has a missing required amount?

Answer: _____

3 Handle duplicate IDs

Which rows must be held because A102 is duplicated, and who should confirm the correction?

Answer: _____

4 Reconcile the rows

There are four source data rows and two held rows. How many rows are ready, and what equation checks the count?

Answer: _____

5 Decide whether to release

When can you release A101 and A104? What should happen before the held rows are released?

Answer: _____

Answer key

1. Keep the original unchanged and work on a copy.

2. Source row 3 has an empty amount_usd field.

3. Hold source rows 3 and 4. The data owner must confirm the ID correction and missing amount; do not guess or silently delete a row.

4. Two rows are ready. The reconciliation is 4 = 2 + 2. Also compare the values against the source.

5. Release A101 and A104 only if partial import is approved; otherwise hold the entire import. Confirm and recheck corrections before releasing held rows.

Alignment: questions 1–3 check review decisions; question 4 checks reconciliation; question 5 checks release decisions. Slides 1–3 use the same terms and row counts.